

Points for Understanding

1

- 1 What time of day was it at the start of the story?
- 2 Who is Martin?
- 3 Where did Kara think they were going?
- 4 Why could Mum not use her mobile phone to find their location?
- 5 How did Kara feel about Howard when she first saw him?
- 6 What happened to the road sign?

2

- 1 Did Kara like Owl Hall when she first saw it?
- 2 What did Kara notice in the courtyard?
- 3 How many holiday homes were there at Owl Hall?
- 4 What was on the wall of Kara's room?
- 5 Could Kara log on to the Internet on the laptop?
- 6 Why was Martin nervous at the end of the chapter?

3

- 1 Kara said to Mum, 'Are you worried I'm going to do something stupid again?' What do you think Kara meant?
- 2 What was Martin doing when Kara walked into the living room?
- 3 Did Mum want to talk about 'the incident' at breakfast?
- 4 What did Kara use to film the video?
- 5 What did Kara think she saw when she filmed the barn?

4

- 1 When did Martin's character start to change?
- 2 Who did Kara and Martin think lived in the house on the hill?
- 3 What did they see when they watched the video?
- 4 Why did Mum ask Kara to make some tea?

5

- 1 What did the colours in the van Gogh painting make Kara think of?
- 2 Why did Kara tell Martin that he could not go with her to the barn?
- 3 Why was Kara surprised when she saw the inside of the barn?
- 4 Why did Kara wonder if her mother had met Howard before?
- 5 What did Martin want to do after supper?
- 6 How did Kara stop Martin from finding the spy?

6

- 1 What was Kara looking at when she first saw the boy?
- 2 Why did the boy like the barn?
- 3 Did Kara tell the boy what the voice said when she arrived at Owl Hall? Why? / Why not?
- 4 On the stairs, Martin said, 'Last night you lied to me, Kara.' What did he mean?
- 5 Why did Kara stay with Martin for the rest of the day?

7

- 1 What did Kara hear in the middle of the night?
- 2 Where did she follow the noise to?
- 3 What was Martin doing when Kara found him?
- 4 Why did he run into the building?
- 5 Was Owl Hall really on fire?
- 6 Why was Kara confused when she talked to Martin in his room?

8

- 1 In what ways were Kara and Martin different?
- 2 What was the boy doing when Kara found him in the barn?
- 3 Where was Martin?
- 4 What did Kara see from the top of the hill on the other side of the wood?
- 5 What was near the other side of the lake?
- 6 How did they get there?
- 7 Why did the boy think they were both at Owl Hall?

9

- 1 What did Kara do as soon as she got back to the house?
- 2 What was strange about Martin's room when Kara went in?
- 3 Where did Howard say Martin was?
- 4 Where did Kara go to look for Martin?
- 5 What did Kara learn about Howard in his house?
- 6 What did Kara hear in the house?
- 7 What idea do you think Kara had at the end of the chapter?

10

- 1 What was strange about John's room?
- 2 What did Kara and John find in the basement of Howard's house?
- 3 Who said, 'I want Martin out of our lives'?
- 4 Why did John think the barn was a safe place to hide?
- 5 When did 'the incident' happen?

11

- 1 What did Mum and Dad tell Kara and Martin six months ago?
- 2 Why did Martin keep lighting fires?
- 3 Who did Martin say was responsible for the problems at home?
- 4 What happened to Martin?
- 5 What did Kara suddenly think was the real reason John became her friend?

12

- 1 Why did the doctor encourage his patients to keep a blog?
- 2 Did Mum think 'the incident' was Kara's fault?
- 3 If John does not work for the doctor, who is he?
- 4 How did John find out about Kara's story?
- 5 When Kara first arrived at Owl Hall she heard a voice whisper, 'Kara! Help me. Let me go!' Whose voice was it?
- 6 When John gave Kara the book, why do you think he said, 'Chapter Thirteen is the best part'?